



Re: RTSL UW CVH Modeling Research

Organizer Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>
Meeting time Thu 7/23/2026 3:00 PM - 4:00 PM
Recurrence Occurs every fourth Thursday from 3:00 PM to 4:00 PM effective Wed 7/22/2026
My response Not yet responded
Required attendees Andrew Moran, David Watkins, William R Garcia, Laura Cobb, Obehi Aimiosior, Zina Abourjeily, mmarklu1
Optional attendees Nicole Ide, Lindsay Steele, Liz Drummond
Message sent Fri 7/24/2026 2:18 PM

Hi All,

Thank you for a productive meeting yesterday! Pasted below are the notes. Please feel free to add anything I may have missed or clarify.

Fiscal Policy

Discussion

- The group discussed substantial uncertainty around applying existing food price elasticity estimates to high-sodium foods specifically, as empirical evidence for salty-food taxation remains limited.
- Key considerations included whether available elasticity estimates from broader food categories are appropriate for high-sodium products; potential differences in responsiveness between salty foods and other taxed products, such as sugar-sweetened beverages; and the need for clear justification and sensitivity analyses given likely scrutiny during peer review.

Decisions

- Maintain a simple, transparent approach for the Bloomberg modeling exercise.
- Continue using the Philippines modeling work as the primary reference point while documenting assumptions and uncertainty.
- Support development of sensitivity analyses and supporting evidence on price elasticity estimates.
- Fiscal policy should remain lower priority than packaged-food trend modeling and LSS refinement for the immediate Bloomberg inputs.

LSS

Discussion

- UW presented two broad approaches: (1) using effect sizes derived from the China Salt Substitute and Stroke Study, (2) or modeling sodium and potassium changes directly and translating them into blood pressure and CVD effects, consistent with previous work by Matti and colleagues.

- o Approach 1 only works for scenarios 4 and 5, but not scenario 2 (general population)
- o Approach 1 would need to be adjusted based on population discretionary intake—not yet incorporated
- Concerns that applying SSaSS relative risks to the general population may not be conceptually consistent because trial participants were predominantly higher-risk individuals.
- At the same time, restricting impacts only to people with hypertension may underestimate population benefits, since LSS can also reduce blood pressure among individuals without hypertension

Decisions / Direction

- William to investigate whether it is feasible to model using approach 2 so that scenario 2 can be incorporated into the model

Euromonitor Data for packaged food sales trend

Discussion

- Matti reviewed analyses of packaged-food market trends using Euromonitor sales data. UW had initially used a single average annual percentage change of approximately 2.6% across countries for simplicity.
- The group agreed that country-specific trends would likely be more appropriate because packaged-food market growth differs considerably across countries.
- Discussion focused on which Euromonitor categories should be included as major sodium sources; whether rice, pasta, and noodle categories should remain included given concerns that low-sodium staple products could dilute trends—no strong opinion either way from RTSL
- Need to determine a “max” proportion of sodium from packaged foods
 - o Matti has previously chosen 50% for modeling work in India

Decision

- Use country-specific Euromonitor trends rather than a single global estimate where feasible; Matti to provide sales-volume based increases

Due outs

- Euromonitor trend estimates by country and determine whether or not to include Rice (Matti)
- Investigate Na/K approach to modeling LSS instead of just RR (William)
 - o *Note: Fiscal policy is lowest priority for BP proposal*
- Determine what visualizations would be best suited for the BP proposal (RTSL team)

Very Best,
Zina

From: amoran@resolvetosavelives.org

When: 4:00 PM - 5:00 PM July 23, 2026

Subject: RTSL UW CVH Modeling Research

Location: Microsoft Teams Meeting

Andrew Moran is inviting you to a scheduled Zoom meeting.

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://resolvetosavelives.zoom.us/j/92449614866>

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For organizers:

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Re: Packaged food trend estimates for sodium modelling

From Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>

Date Thu 7/23/2026 11:07 AM

To William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Cc David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; lcobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>

Hi William and all,

I am happy to discuss this further on the call today. One tricky thing is that we have trends by food categories, and I assume that you would prefer one trend for all major sodium sources among packaged foods. We can discuss if we should try to combine sales volumes across categories and then estimate trends or pool category-specific trends using meta-analysis. I am looking forward to our discussion this afternoon.

Best,

Matti

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, July 21, 2026 6:35 PM

To: Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>

Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; lcobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>

Subject: Re: Packaged food trend estimates for sodium modelling

External Email - Use Caution

Hi Matti,

Thanks for sharing, this looks great! On our side, we'll adapt the model to include a trend assumption that can be incorporated based on the inputs. Happy to discuss this further during Thursday's meeting.

Best,

William

From: Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, July 21, 2026 4:07 PM

To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide

<nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; lcobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>

Subject: Packaged food trend estimates for sodium modelling

Hi William and all,

Please find attached an Excel file with trend estimates for a selected set of packaged food categories calculated from the Euromonitor that are likely to be important sources of dietary sodium. A brief description of the selected categories, the workbook structure, and the trend measures used is provided in first sheet (README).

The workbook includes:

- All observed years (2011–2025)
- Post-COVID period (2023–2025)
- Last observed year and Euromonitor predictions (2025–2030)

I am happy to discuss this in more detail, including which estimates may be most appropriate to use and whether we should attempt to combine some.

Best regards,

Matti



Philippines tax study

From Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>

Date Thu 7/23/2026 4:27 PM

To William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Hi William,

Thanks for leading a productive meeting! I will send out notes tomorrow.

It would be great if you could read this study in more detail to make sure the effect size estimate is being correctly inputted into the model, particularly as it relates to the effect size over time. The details are outside of my expertise and difficult for me to grasp, but Matti can always help clarify.

[Estimated health impact, cost, and cost-effectiveness of taxation on unhealthy packaged foods in the Philippines: a modelling study](#)

Very Best,
Zina

Zina Abourjeily (She/Her) ([Hear my name](#))
Program Officer, Nutrition Policy
zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org



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Potassium resources

From David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>

Date Fri 6/26/2026 2:50 PM

To William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Here are data on regional average potassium consumption that can be used for baseline potassium in the model.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10349712/>

And of course the relationship between potassium supplementation and blood pressure. Note that the effects are larger (a) in persons with HTN, who are (b) not on HTN medication (see fig 5). We could do a weighted average effect size for each country based on treatment % from NCD-RisC. We can discuss next week.

<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/32500831/>

DW

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